PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Alumni Portal

How an internal HR pain point inspired a self-serve document portal that eliminated post-exit admin overhead entirely

Internally Discovered | Limited-Access Portal | Admin One-Time Setup | Consumption-Based Add-On

Devayani Bhosale · Product Manager · Greytip Software (greytHR) · 2022–2024

02 The Problem

ORIGIN

Discovered internally — not from a customer complaint

During an internal meeting with our HR managers, we uncovered a recurring frustration: exited employees frequently contacted HR to request documents and statutory forms they had missed or lost after their last day.

The irony was clear that existing employees had instant access to all their documents through the employee portal. But the moment someone left the organisation, that access was revoked immediately, leaving them entirely dependent on HR for anything they needed afterwards.

This was creating an invisible but significant admin burden that no one had formally flagged as a product problem.

Insight: The solution already existed; we just needed to extend access, not build something new

Admin Email Overhead

HR admins had to manually search for exited employee records, locate the relevant documents, and manage back-and-forth email trails for alumni.

Instant Access Revocation

Employee portal access was cut off the moment an employee left; even if they had pending statutory forms or documents they needed for tax, legal, or personal purposes.

No Scalable Solution

For medium to large organisations with frequent exits, this created a disproportionate admin burden with no self-serve alternative for the alumnus or the HR team.

03

My Role & Process

Key PM Decision: Rather than building a brand new post-exit tool, we extended the existing employee portal with limited access; reducing engineering effort dramatically and getting to market faster while reusing a UI employees already knew.

Pricing strategy: Launched as a consumption-based add-on. Admin enables once, sets an access duration, and pays per alumnus accessing the portal. Low friction to adopt, scalable for large organisations.

1 Discovery

Internal HR meeting surfaced the pain point
Confirmed no existing solution in platform

2 Validate

Spoke to medium and large business customers
Confirmed admin overhead was real and widespread

3 Define & Design

Defined limited access scope
Designed admin one-time setup
Set duration configuration

4 Build & Test

Extended existing employee portal
Built access revocation logic
QA for edge cases on exit flow

5 Launch

Released as consumption add-on
Targeted medium to large orgs
Customer enablement

04

The Solution

A limited-access extension of the existing employee portal; giving alumni self-serve access to their documents for a configurable period after exit, with zero ongoing admin effort.

FOR THE ADMIN

1. Enable Alumni Portal once from the admin settings: A single toggle for the entire organisation
2. Set the access duration: How many months after exit the alumnus can access the portal
3. Done. No further action required. The system handles access automatically for every exiting employee

FOR THE ALUMNUS

1. Receives continued access to their employee portal login after their exit date
2. Sees a limited view: Only their own documents, forms, and statutory records relevant to their tenure
3. Downloads whatever they need, whenever they need it. No emails, no waiting, no chasing HR

05 Outcome & Learnings

150+

Customers activated within 6 months

1000+

Alumni accessed the portal

1x

Admin setup needed for all alumni

Adoption was strongest in medium to large business units where alumni volume justified the add-on. 150+ customers activated the portal within 6 months of release, with 1,000+ alumni independently accessing their documents; removing that overhead from HR entirely.

LEARNINGS

- The best product insights sometimes come from inside the building. Internal stakeholders who live with the product daily can surface pain points that no support ticket ever captures
- Extending an existing product is often better than building new and reusing the employee portal reduced engineering effort and gave alumni a familiar interface from day one
- Pricing for the right segment unlocked the adoption, positioning the portal as a consumption-based add-on for medium to large organisations matched the problem to the customers most likely to feel it